What was Megasthenes doing in this part of India? Many Greek chroniclers and writers had been to India before him, the largest number having been part of the entourage of the Macedonian Alexander when he overran large parts of the north-west in the spring of 326 BCE. While the plains of Punjab figure prominently in their descriptions of Alexander's army as it sailed down rivers and marched across the Indus plains, they neither ventured further downstream nor south-east along the flow of the Ganga. Unlike his predecessors, Megasthenes did. He travelled much further and saw more of India, especially Gangetic India, than any foreigner before him. Starting off from Arachosia, he went across Punjab and the Gangetic plains to spend time at the court of 'Sandrakottos, king of the Indians', Sandrakottos being Greek for Chandragupta. Arachosia was located in the Helmand area of what is now south Afghanistan, and the region known by that name possibly stretched till the upper reaches of the Indus river. It was controlled by Sibyrtius, a satrap (governor) originally appointed by Alexander, and Megasthenes was part of this satrap's staff. He seems to have spent some time in Arachosia, but if he had any thoughts about that province he does not share them with us, nor says anything of note about the places that he saw or the people he met there. We do not even know for certain who he represented at the court of Chandragupta, though it is likely that he travelled at the Macedonian satrap's behest.[12] That he should have arrived from Arachosia is not surprising, for Chandragupta himself, after he had conquered the Nanda kingdom and ascended the throne at Pataliputra, is known to have had territorial designs on the Indus plains and beyond. Whether the region bordering that river had been annexed by Chandragupta by the time Megasthenes visited Pataliputra is a matter of some controversy.[13] The fact that he visited Chandragupta's capital city and left an eyewitness account of it, however, is universally acknowledged,[14] despite the original text in which he penned his account having been swallowed up by the sands of time.